

SOC INVESTIGATION REPORT

Phishing Email Analysis

1. Executive Summary

This report documents the investigation of a suspicious email reported by multiple users. The analysis identified several indicators that are consistent with a phishing attack. These include a spoofed sender address, failed email authentication checks, and the use of a shortened malicious link. Based on the findings, the email has been classified as a phishing attempt.

2. Incident Description

Several employees reported receiving an email that appeared to be from Netflix. The email urged users to take immediate action and contained a link. Upon inspection, the sender address and content raised suspicion, indicating a possible phishing attempt.

3. Investigation Methodology

The investigation followed standard SOC procedures:

- Reviewed the email headers to check authentication results
 - Identified the originating IP address and sender information
 - Extracted domains and URLs from the email
 - Analyzed indicators using threat intelligence tools
 - Compared findings with known phishing techniques
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4. Evidence and Findings

4.1 Email Header Analysis

The email header analysis revealed that SPF validation failed, meaning the sender was not authorized to send emails on behalf of the domain. DKIM and DMARC checks were not properly configured, which further increases suspicion. The sender's domain does not match the legitimate Netflix domain.

4.2 Source Analysis

The originating IP address identified was 209.85.167.226. The email passed through multiple mail servers before reaching the recipient. This behavior is often seen in phishing campaigns to disguise the true origin of the email.

4.3 Domain Analysis

A suspicious domain, etekno.xyz, was identified within the email. This domain is not associated with Netflix and appears to be malicious or untrusted. Attackers often use such domains to host phishing pages.

4.4 URL Analysis

The email contained a shortened URL:

hxxps://t[.]co/yuxfZm8KPg?amp=1

Shortened URLs are commonly used in phishing attacks to hide the actual destination and prevent users from identifying malicious links.

4.5 Social Engineering Indicators

The email used several common phishing techniques, including:

- Impersonation of a well-known brand (Netflix)
- Creating urgency to prompt user action
- Misleading sender information

These tactics are designed to trick users into clicking malicious links or providing sensitive information.

5. Analysis

The combination of failed authentication checks, suspicious domain usage, and hidden URLs strongly indicates that this email is a phishing attempt. The behavior matches known phishing attack patterns used to steal user credentials.

6. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

This attack is mapped to:

T1566 – Phishing

7. Risk Assessment

Severity: Medium to High

Impact: Potential credential theft and unauthorized access

Likelihood: High, due to multiple indicators of phishing

8. Recommendations

The following actions are recommended:

- Block the domain etekno.xyz at the email gateway
 - Block the malicious URL at network level
 - Quarantine similar emails automatically
 - Educate users on identifying phishing emails
 - Enforce stronger email authentication policies such as SPF, DKIM, and DMARC
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9. Conclusion

The investigation confirms that the email is a phishing attempt designed to deceive users and potentially steal credentials. Immediate action should be taken to block the identified indicators and prevent further exposure.